

AI PERMIT FIELD GUIDE



VERSION 4 / SUMMER 2026

AI Literacy. AI Fluency. AI Design Thinking.

An evidence trail for responsible use.

Use AI with intention. Document with integrity.

AI PERMIT

AI LICENSE

SPIRAL + EVIDENCE

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RELATIONSHIP

BE THE OUTSIDE CAT.

Schools do not need more AI use. They need a healthier relationship with it. There are three ways to live with a powerful tool.

01 THE WILD CAT

Avoids the house entirely.

Refuses AI on principle. Stays independent, but pretends the house is not there — and students already live in it.

02 THE HOUSE CAT

Depends on the house.

Reaches for AI first, every time. Comfortable, fast, and slowly unable to work without it.

03 THE OUTSIDE CAT

Goes in, gets what it needs, leaves.

Uses AI deliberately, keeps its own judgment, and can always walk away. The stance this guide teaches.

OUTSIDE CAT PATH

01

ENTER

Start with a real task, question, or stuck point.

02

TAKE

Use the help that improves your thinking or draft.

03

LEAVE

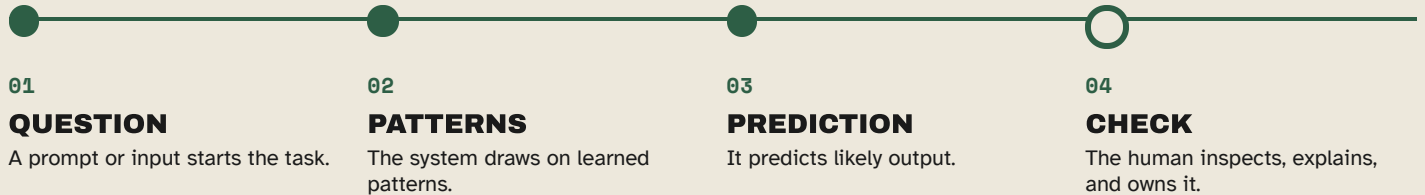
Return ownership to your judgment before anything ships.

Responsible use includes the decision not to use AI. The goal is intentional, transparent, responsible use.

PLAIN ENGLISH

WHAT AI IS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH.

AI systems find patterns in data and make predictions. Generative AI produces text, images, audio, and other outputs from patterns learned during training.



FLUENCY IS NOT EVIDENCE.

Treat AI output as a prediction to inspect.

AI IS NOT A PERSON.

Treat the output as something to inspect.

AI IS NOT A SEARCH ENGINE.

It can sound certain and still be wrong.

AI IS NOT A SOURCE OF VERIFIED TRUTH.

Verify it before you explain or own it.

TEACHER NOTE — If it reads well, ask whether you know it is right.

EVERYDAY AI

AI ALREADY SHOWS UP IN ORDINARY TOOLS.

You have likely used AI for years. This page lowers the fear before the technical page.

01 RECOMMENDATIONS Suggests what to watch, buy, read, or play.	02 SPAM AND FRAUD Flags unusual patterns and suspicious messages.	RULES ERA If-this-then-that logic.
03 TRANSLATION Converts language and predicts useful phrasing.	04 NAVIGATION Estimates routes, traffic, and arrival times.	MACHINE LEARNING Systems learn from examples.
05 WRITING SUPPORT Predicts spelling, grammar, and phrasing help.	06 ADAPTIVE LEARNING Adjusts practice from performance patterns.	DEEP LEARNING Large pattern systems improve perception.
		GENERATIVE AI Systems produce new text, images, audio, and code.

General AI — one system that outperforms humans across everything — is still theoretical. Do not let headlines about that stop judgment about tools you already use.

MODEL MECHANICS

HOW AI MODELS WORK.

Demystify the vocabulary without turning this into a computer science course.

TRAINING THE MODEL		USING THE MODEL	
DATA	Examples the system learns from.	QUESTION	The prompt or input.
ALGORITHM	The learning method.	TOKENS	Input is broken into pieces.
TOKENS	Small pieces of language or data.	PREDICTION	Likely next pieces are generated.
PARAMETERS	Internal settings shaped by training.	OUTPUT	Text, image, audio, code, or other result.
AI MODEL	The trained pattern system.	HUMAN CHECK	Judgment verifies and revises.



The model is predicting from patterns. That can be useful, but prediction is not the same as verified truth.

ALWAYS ON

FOUR HABITS STAY ON EVERY TIME.

The AI Core Competencies are not a unit you finish. They are habits that stay on under all AI work.

01



PROMPTING

Ask clearly and intentionally.

Risk: a vague prompt returns a generic essay.

02



DATA & PRIVACY

Do not share private or sensitive information.

Risk: pasting student names, grades, or an IEP into a chatbot.

03



ETHICS

Ask whether this should be generated at all.

Risk: an AI-written personal reflection becomes a false record.

04



VERIFICATION

Check facts, sources, and assumptions.

Risk: a plausible invented citation survives until someone checks.

REMOVE THE IDENTIFIER

STUDENT [REDACTED] GRADE [REDACTED]
 TASK **Revise a claim with evidence.**
 RECORD [REDACTED] ID / SSN [REDACTED]

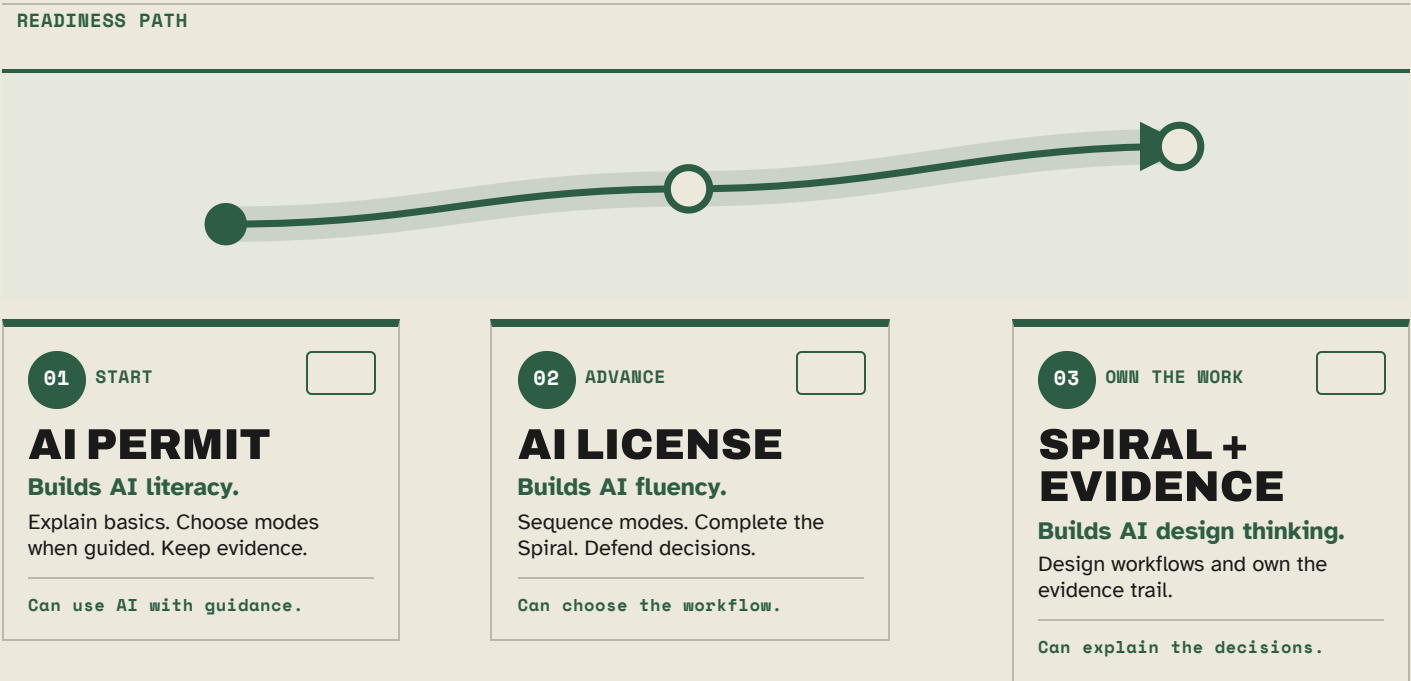
1. Name, grade, SSN, IEP, 504, health, credentials, tests: out.
2. Keep the task. Remove the identifier.
3. Use samples, public rubrics, approved tools, or ask first.

Classroom scenario: all four habits fire at once when a student asks AI to revise a persuasive paragraph.

READINESS PATH

THE AI PERMIT PATH STARTS WITH LITERACY.

A permit means you drive. AI should amplify your effort, not replace your direction.



UNDERSTAND THE TOOL

Know what AI is and is not.

CHOOSE THE RIGHT MODE

Match help to the task.

LEAVE EVIDENCE

Show process and judgment.

AI Permit is a learning stage inside the AI Production Framework, not an official credential unless adopted by a school or program.

AI MODES

THE MODE MATTERS BECAUSE THE TASK MATTERS.

AI Modes are mindsets, not buttons. Naming the mode signals the kind of help you want.

01	IDEA MODE Explore possibilities.	USE WHEN Use when you need directions, options, or questions.	SIGNAL VERBS generate, imagine, explore, combine, reframe
02	LEARNING MODE Build understanding.	USE WHEN Use when the concept, task, or vocabulary is unclear.	SIGNAL VERBS explain, clarify, model, connect, scaffold
03	FEEDBACK MODE Improve a draft or idea.	USE WHEN Use when you need critique aligned to a goal or rubric.	SIGNAL VERBS critique, compare, diagnose, verify, prioritize
04	TOOL MODE Organize or transform.	USE WHEN Use when existing information needs structure.	SIGNAL VERBS organize, transform, draft, build, produce
05	PRACTICE MODE Rehearse and stress-test.	USE WHEN Use when you need challenge, roleplay, or pressure.	SIGNAL VERBS role-play, rehearse, challenge, stress-test

MINDSET	VERBS	PROMPT
The mode is not a feature, button, or setting.	The verbs tell AI what kind of help you want.	Use Lens + Context + Action to start cleanly.

PRACTICE

MODE MATCHING QUICK CHECK.

Pick the first mode from the immediate need. Task first. Mode second. Tool last.

MODE BANK: IDEA · LEARNING · FEEDBACK · TOOL · PRACTICE

01	I do not understand this concept yet.	FIRST MODE / REASON
02	I have a draft and need critique.	FIRST MODE / REASON
03	I need a table from my notes.	FIRST MODE / REASON
04	I want to test whether my argument holds up.	FIRST MODE / REASON
05	I need several possible project directions.	FIRST MODE / REASON
06	I need to decide what to ask AI first.	FIRST MODE / REASON
07	I want to check whether a claim is supported.	FIRST MODE / REASON
08	I need to explain why I rejected a suggestion.	FIRST MODE / REASON

Model your reasoning: the immediate need determines the first mode. 'I do not understand this concept yet' starts in Learning Mode because the need is understanding, not drafting.



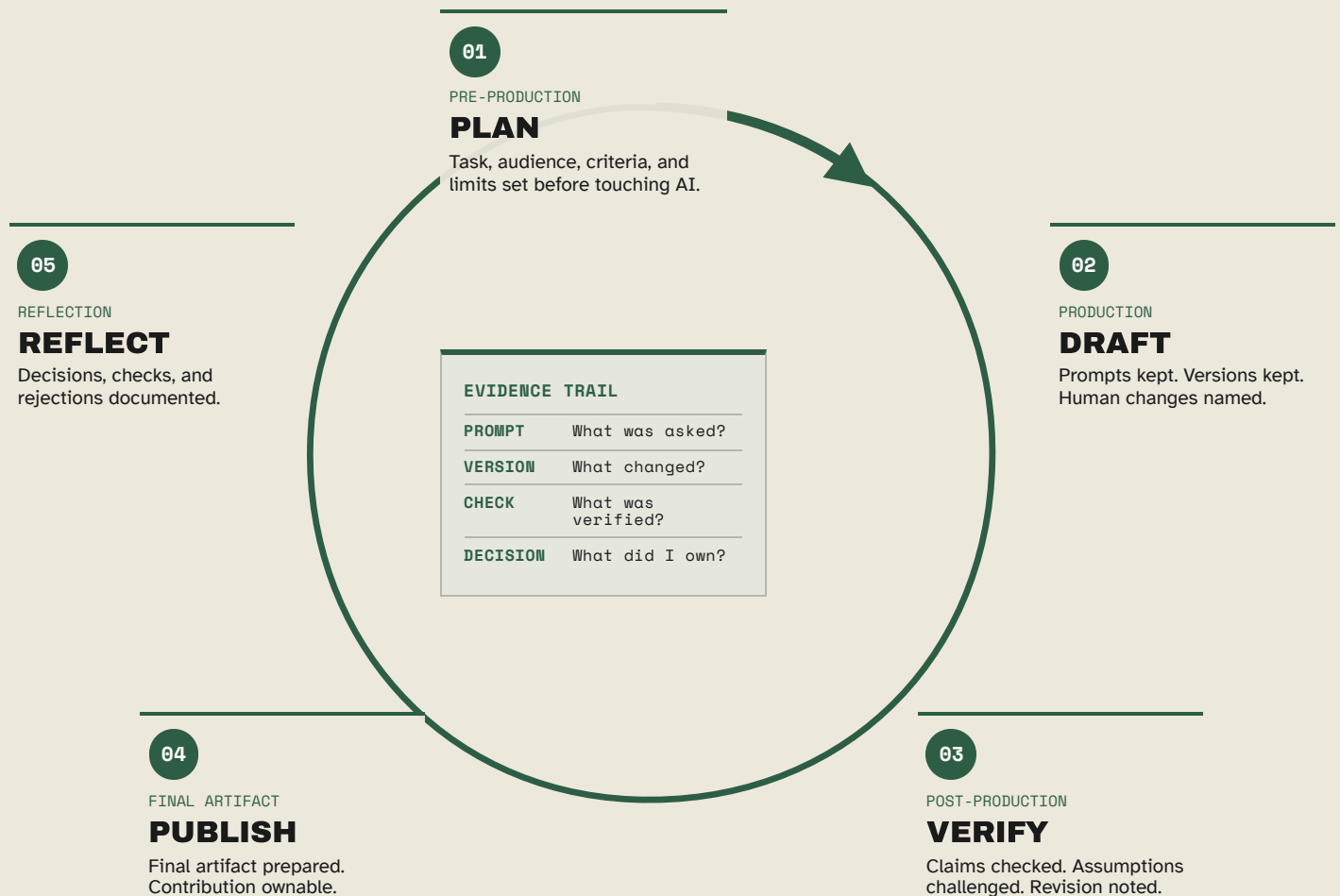
KEY / PATHWAY
RESOURCE

KEY: 01 LEARNING · 02 FEEDBACK · 03 TOOL · 04 PRACTICE · 05 IDEA · 06 IDEA · 07 FEEDBACK · 08 NOT A
MODE — THAT IS YOUR EVIDENCE LOG

PRODUCTION SPIRAL

THE PRODUCTION SPIRAL MAKES AI USE VISIBLE.

The final product matters, but the process tells the story.



Students should be able to show decisions, checks, revisions, and reflection.

EVIDENCE LOG

EVIDENCE LOGS SHOW PROCESS WITHOUT SURVEILLANCE.

The Evidence Log shows AI was used as a tool, not a shortcut.

01 / STEP · TIME Draft 1	02 / MODE USED Feedback Mode	03 / PROMPT · QUESTION Act as a reviewer. Where is my claim weak?
04 / WHY THIS MODE I had a draft and needed critique.	05 / WHAT CHANGED Revised evidence and clarified the claim.	06 / VERIFICATION · ETHICS Checked source date and kept my own wording.

NEED MORE ROWS? COPY THIS PAGE. THAT IS WHAT IT IS FOR.

01 / STEP · TIME write the evidence here	02 / MODE USED write the evidence here	03 / PROMPT · QUESTION write the evidence here
04 / WHY THIS MODE write the evidence here	05 / WHAT CHANGED write the evidence here	06 / VERIFICATION · ETHICS write the evidence here

KEEP THE RECEIPT — The log is not surveillance. It shows what AI generated and what the human questioned, selected, revised, verified, or rejected.

CHECKLIST

BEFORE AI-SUPPORTED WORK LEAVES THE ROOM.

AI can help, but the human still has to steer. Run the final check before AI-supported work is submitted.

- ☐ Did I decide whether AI belongs here?
- ☐ Did I define the task before using AI?
- ☐ Did I choose the right mode?
- ☐ Did I avoid private or sensitive data?
- ☐ Did I check facts or claims?
- ☐ Did I revise with human judgment?
- ☐ Can I explain what AI did and what I did?
- ☐ Did I save enough evidence to show my process?

01

GET THE WORKSHOP PACKET

Use the expanded packet for live-session practice.

02

BRING THE PATHWAY TO YOUR SCHOOL

Move from shared literacy to classroom workflows.

03

JOIN THE RESOURCE LIST

Get new classroom-ready AI literacy tools.

WANT HELP BRINGING THIS TO YOUR STAFF OR CLASSROOM?

Bring the AI Permit to AI License pathway to your school, or join the resource list for new classroom-ready AI literacy tools.

[VINCEDOUD.COM](https://vinedoud.com) / VINCEANDREWDOUD@GMAIL.COM

